Methods

This section details the methodology used in this analysis, covering data sources, transformations, statistical models, and visualization techniques. **Data Sources**: Polling data was gathered from leading pollsters including Cadem, Criteria, Plaza Pública, Data Influye, Activa Research, Feedback, and Ipsos, selected for their data availability, sampling techniques, and internal consistency. Including these varied pollsters ensures a comprehensive view of public opinion across different sampling methods and population representations. The candidates analyzed include: Jeannette Jara, José Antonio Kast, Evelyn Matthei, Johannes Kaiser, Franco Parisi, Harold Mayne-Nicholls, Marco Enríquez, Eduardo Artés . **Data Transformation and Filtering**: Following collection, the data underwent rigorous cleaning and standardization. Dates were processed using the lubridate package and converted into year-week or year-month intervals, supporting accurate and consistent aggregation over time. Missing values (`NAs`) were removed, and candidate-specific averages were calculated, ensuring valid comparisons and reliable trend lines. **Trend Line Methodologies**: The staircase line represents a monthly average of each candidate's support, displayed as to emphasize abrupt shifts or drops in short-term support. The shaded region around the lines represents the margin of error. It is given by a Loess smoothed trend (`loess.sd()`), which is used to capture nonlinear fluctuations and patterns that may not be captured by the simple linear trend. This smoothing model uses a span of 0.66 to balance between fit accuracy and over-smoothing. It offers a 90% prediction interval, reflecting possible future variability. **Statistics**: Statistical labels display each candidate's mean support, standard deviation, and observed support range (minimum and maximum values), giving additional insight into the relative stability or variability of public opinion for each candidate; `beta` symbolizes the variation over a day. `r2` represents the equation fit. `n` represents the number of polls. `mu` represents the average over the whole period of polls fielded. `sigma` represents the standard deviation. `max` represents the maximum polling percentage and `min` represents the minimum polling intention. **Visualization**: Graphs are generated using `ggplot2` and base `R` graphics, with candidate trends color-coded for clarity. **Disclaimer**: The report is based on recent polling data, recognizing that public opinion is dynamic and may continue to shift.